



Trinity College Dublin

Coláiste na Tríonóide, Baile Átha Cliath

The University of Dublin

Dear Editor,

I am a PhD student at Trinity College Dublin, and I am writing to submit our manuscript entitled “Bayesian Latent Class Regression and Variable Selection with Applications to Sleep Patterns Data” for consideration in the *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society, Series C*.

Our paper addresses an important methodological gap in Bayesian latent class regression (LCR) by developing a framework that jointly performs predictor and item variable selection. We employ Pólya-Gamma data augmentation to enable efficient Gibbs sampling and extend this approach to facilitate variable selection for both regression coefficients and categorical items. Through simulation studies, we demonstrate accurate parameter recovery and successful identification of informative variables. We apply our methodology to paediatric sleep health data, identifying four clinically distinct sleep difficulty profiles and revealing the predictive role of Autism Spectrum Disorder diagnosis.

We believe the manuscript will be of interest to readers of JRSS Series C because it combines methodological development with a substantive applied analysis, offering a practical framework for researchers working with latent class models and covariate information in health and social science applications.

This manuscript has not been published elsewhere and is not under consideration by any other journal. All authors have approved the submission. We would be honoured to have our work considered for publication and welcome any feedback during the review process.

Yours sincerely,

Matthew Heaney (on behalf of all authors)
PhD Student
School of Computer Science and Statistics
Trinity College Dublin
heaneym@tcd.ie